Tree Builder: Answer Key

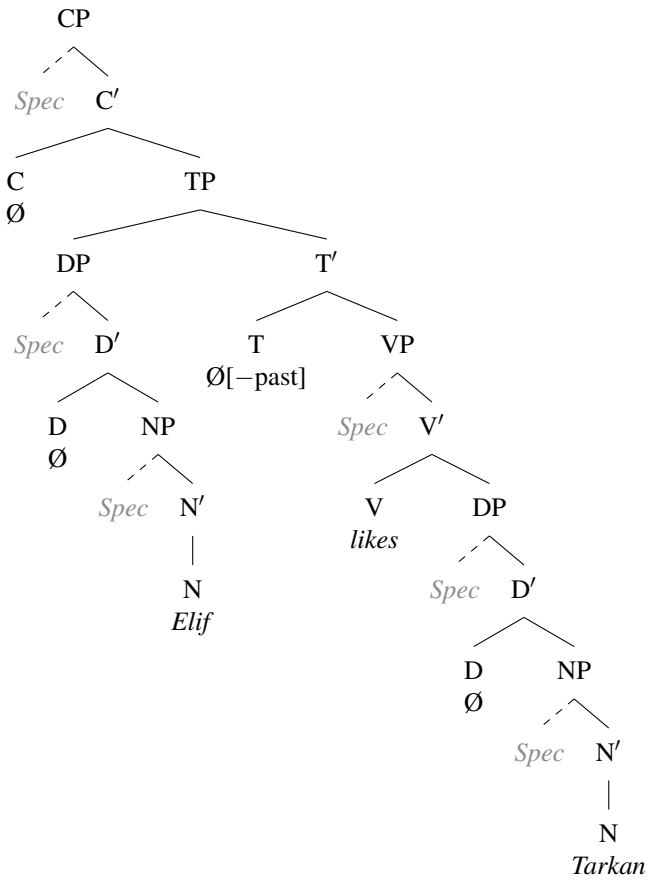
Reading: Andrew Carnie (2013), *Syntax: A Generative Introduction*, 3rd ed., Chapters 6 and 7

Conventions. Every clause is a CP; the main-clause C is Ø. The subject sits in Spec,TP. Modals sit in T, and so does *to*[−tense] in a non-finite clause; with no modal or auxiliary, T is Ø with a tense feature, Ø[+past] or Ø[−past], and the verb keeps the tense ending. D heads DP; names and bare nouns have an empty D (Ø). Complements are sisters of the head; each adjunct gets its own X′. Empty specifier positions are drawn as dashed *Spec* branches. No movement.

1. Level 1: the clause spine

1.1 Elif likes Tarkan.

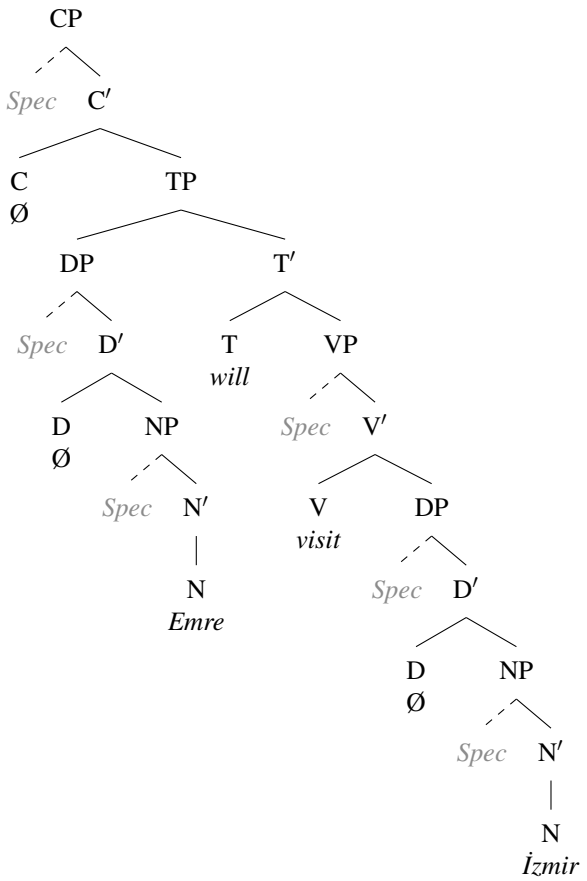
Practice: Ø C, Ø T, names with Ø D as subject and object



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Elif*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[−past]] [VP [V′ [V *likes*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Tarkan*]]]]]]]]]]

1.2 Emre will visit İzmir.

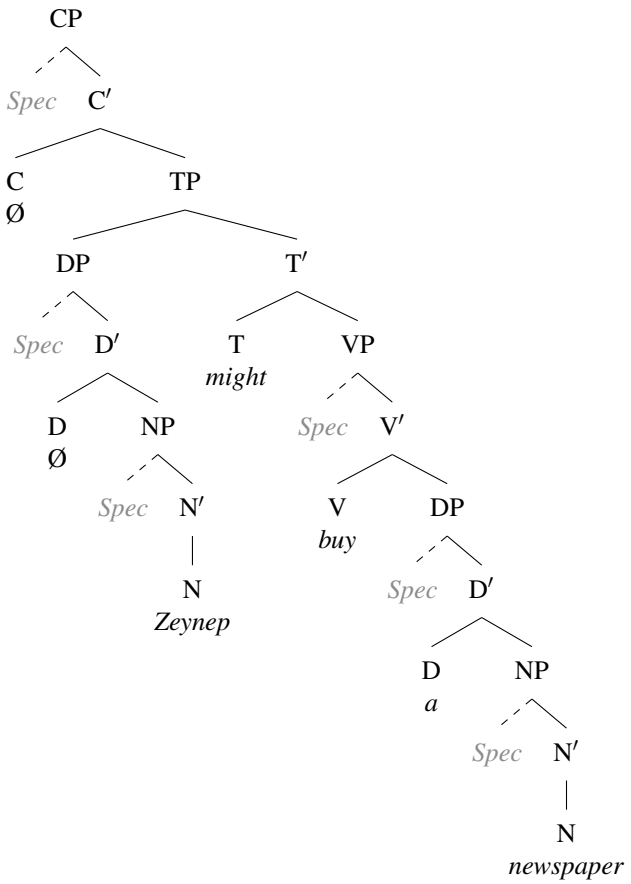
Practice: modal will in T, place name as object DP



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Emre*]]]]] [T′ [T *will*] [VP [V′ [V *visit*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *İzmir*]]]]]]]]]]

1.3 Zeynep might buy a newspaper.

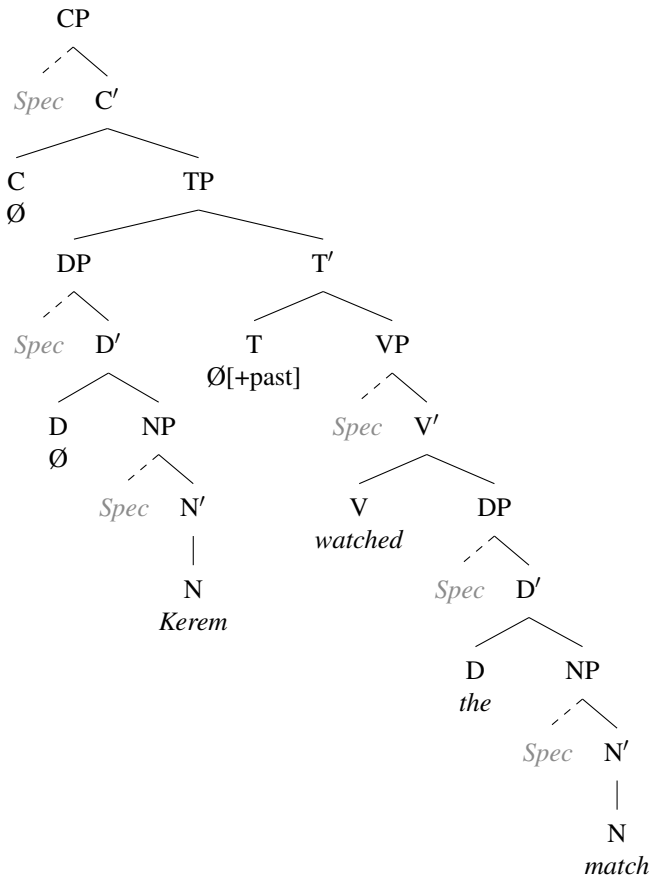
Practice: modal might in T, object DP with overt D a



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Zeynep*]]]]] [T′ [T *might*] [VP [V′ [V *buy*] [DP [D′ [D *a*] [NP [N′ [N *newspaper*]]]]]]]]]]

1.4 Kerem watched the match.

Practice: Ø T with a past-tense verb (no affix lowering), object DP with overt D the

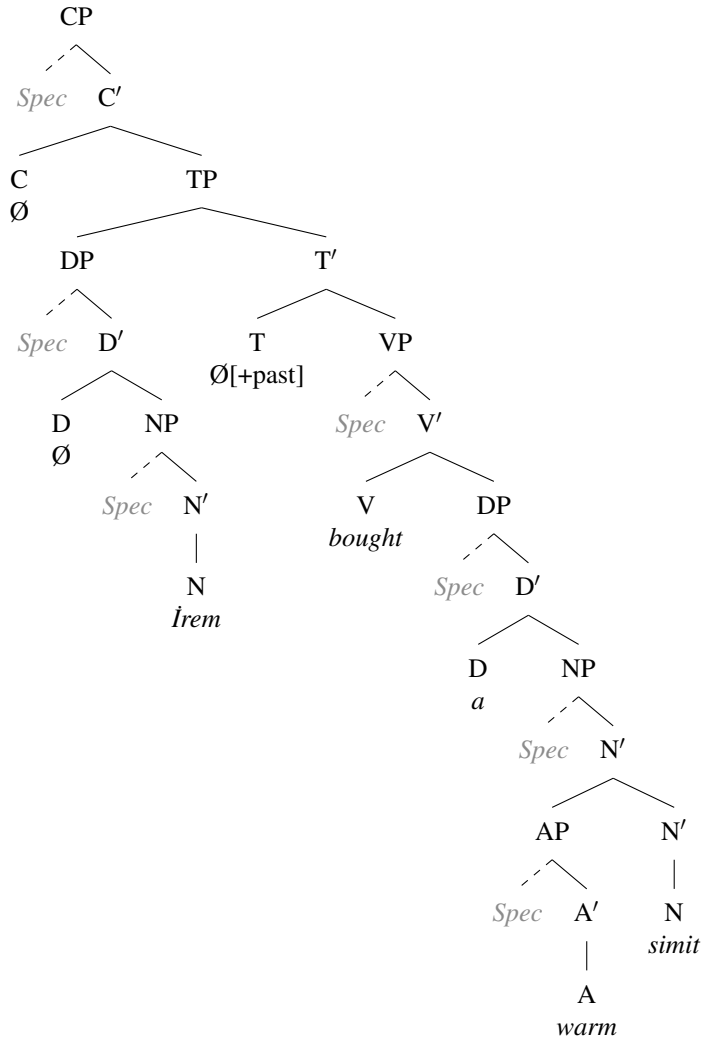


[$_{CP}$ [$_{C'}$ [$_{C}$ Ø] [$_{TP}$ [$_{DP}$ [$_{D'}$ [$_{D}$ Ø] [$_{NP}$ [$_{N'}$ [$_{N}$ *Kerem*]]]]] [$_{T'}$ [$_{T}$ Ø[+past]] [$_{VP}$ [$_{V'}$ [$_{V}$ *watched*] [$_{DP}$ [$_{D'}$ [$_{D}$ *the*] [$_{NP}$ [$_{N'}$ [$_{N}$ *match*]]]]]]]]]]

2. Level 2: inside phrases

2.1 İrem bought a warm simit.

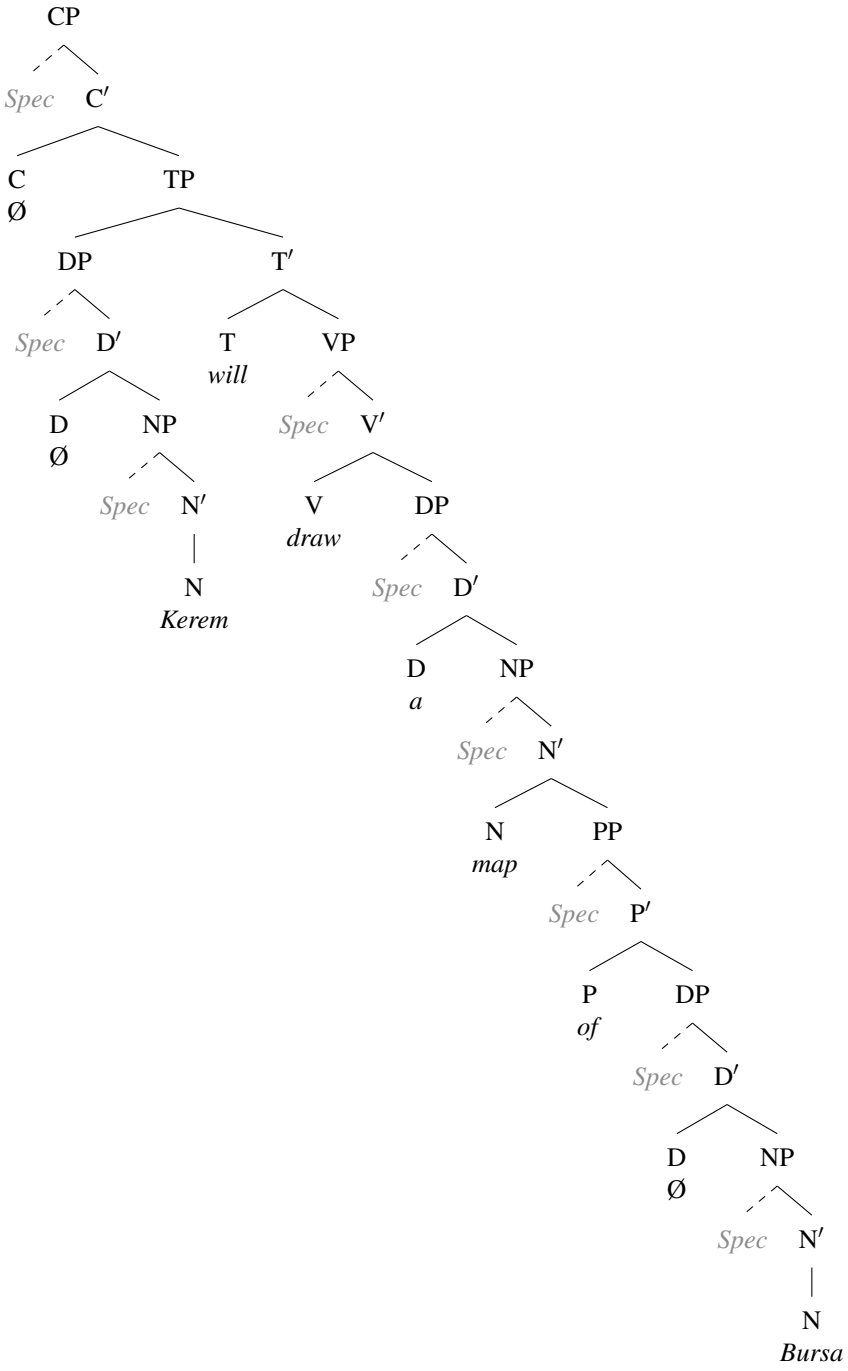
Practice: AP adjunct before a noun: extra N′ above N′–N



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *İrem*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[+past]] [VP [V′ [V *bought*] [DP [D′ [D *a*] [NP [N′ [AP [A′ [A *warm*]]] [N′ [N *simit*]]]]]]]]]]]

2.2 Kerem will draw a map of Bursa.

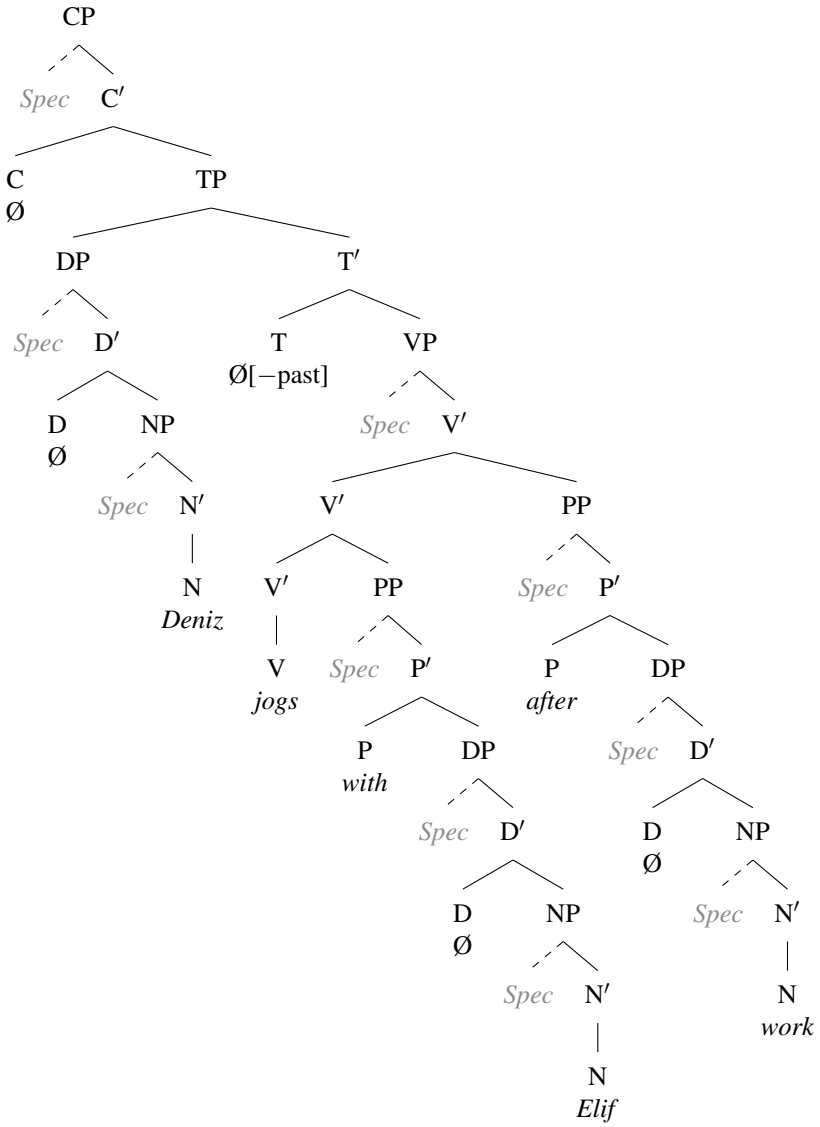
Practice: of-PP as complement of N (sister of N), modal in T



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Kerem*]]]]] [T′ [T *will*] [VP [V′ [V *draw*] [DP [D′ [D *a*] [NP [N′ [N *map*] [PP [P′ [P *of*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Bursa*]]]]]]]]]]]]]]]]

2.3 Deniz jogs with Elif after work.

Practice: two PP adjuncts stacked on V′, same side; the first PP attaches lower

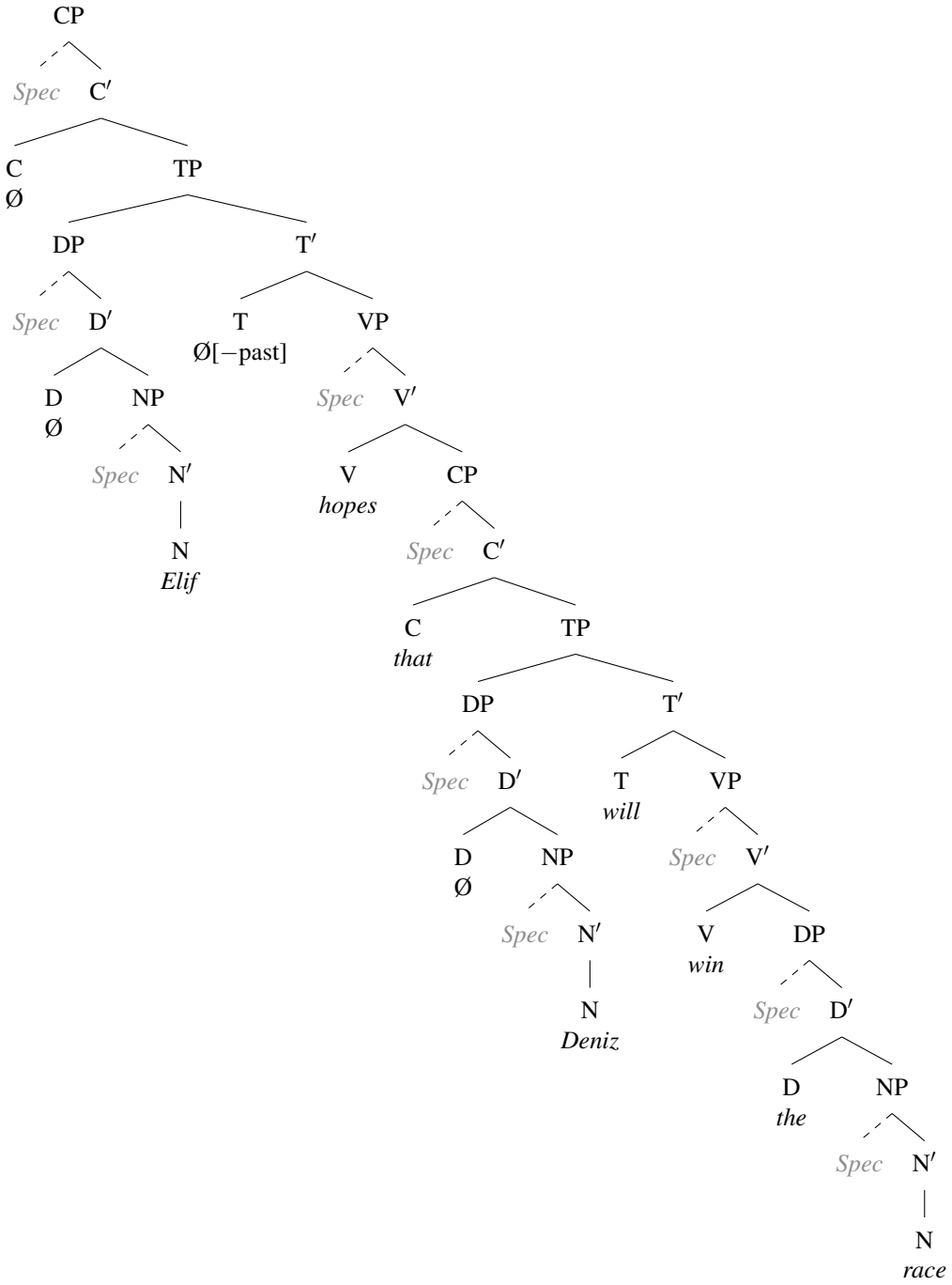


[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Deniz*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[−past]] [VP [V′ [V′ [V′ [V *jogs*]] [PP [P′ [P *with*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Elif*]]]]]]] [PP [P′ [P *after*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *work*]]]]]]]]]]]]]

3. Level 3: embedded clauses

3.1 Elif hopes that Deniz will win the race.

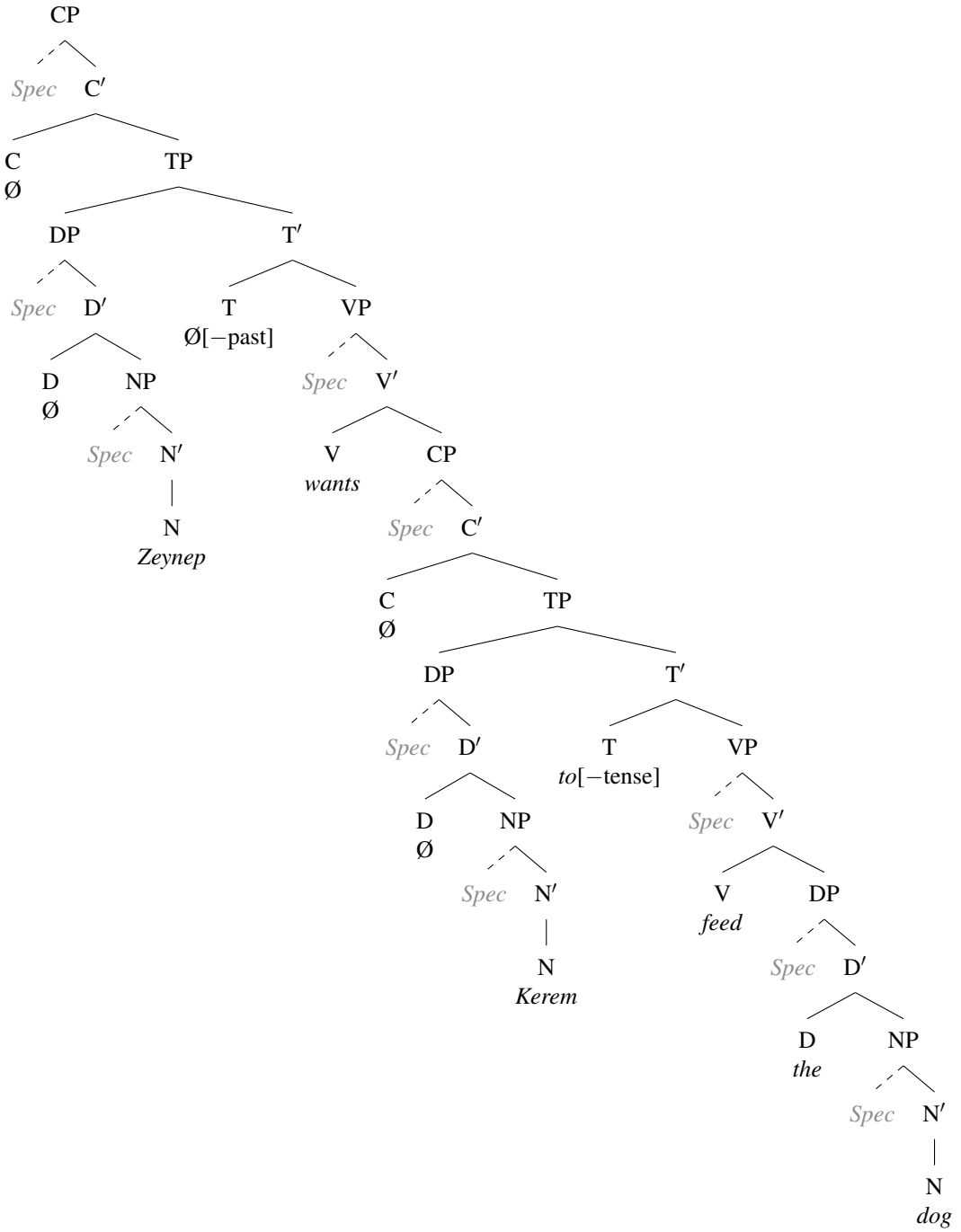
Practice: that-CP as complement of V; modal in the embedded T



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Elif*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[−past]] [VP [V′ [V *hopes*] [CP [C′ [C *that*] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Deniz*]]]]] [T′ [T *will*] [VP [V′ [V *win*] [DP [D′ [D *the*] [NP [N′ [N *race*]]]]

3.2 Zeynep wants Kerem to feed the dog.

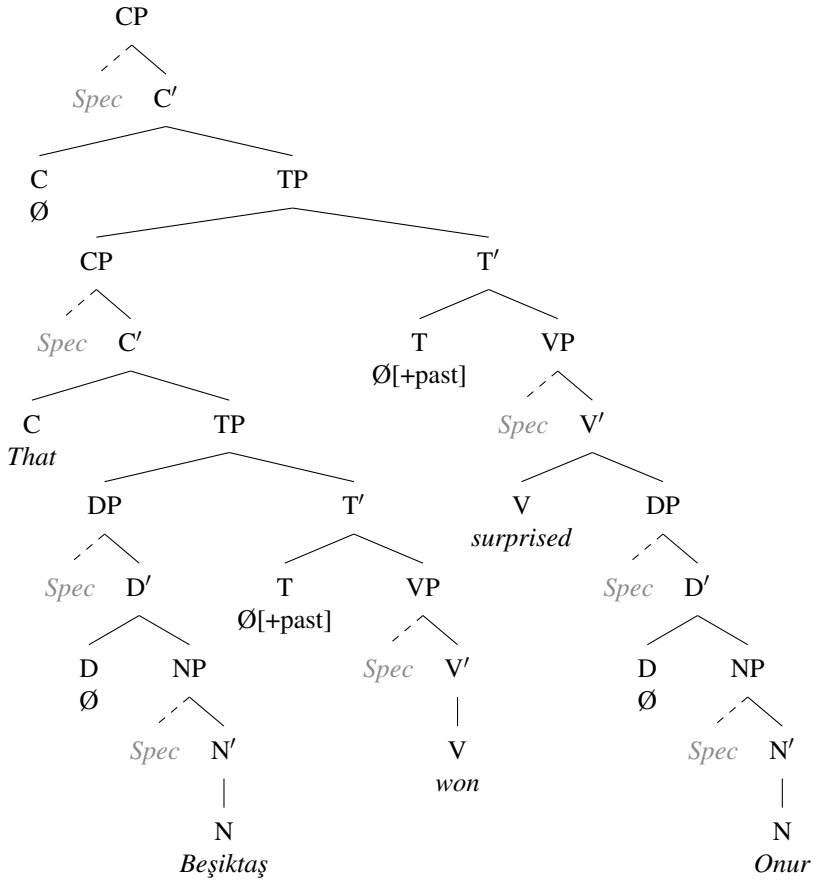
Practice: non-finite CP complement: to in T, the embedded subject in Spec,TP, an empty embedded C



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Zeynep*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[−past]] [VP [V′ [V *wants*] [CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Kerem*]]]]] [T′ [T *to*[−tense]] [VP [V′ [V *feed*] [DP [D′ [D *the*] [NP [N′ [N *dog*]]]]

3.3 That Beşiktaş won surprised Onur.

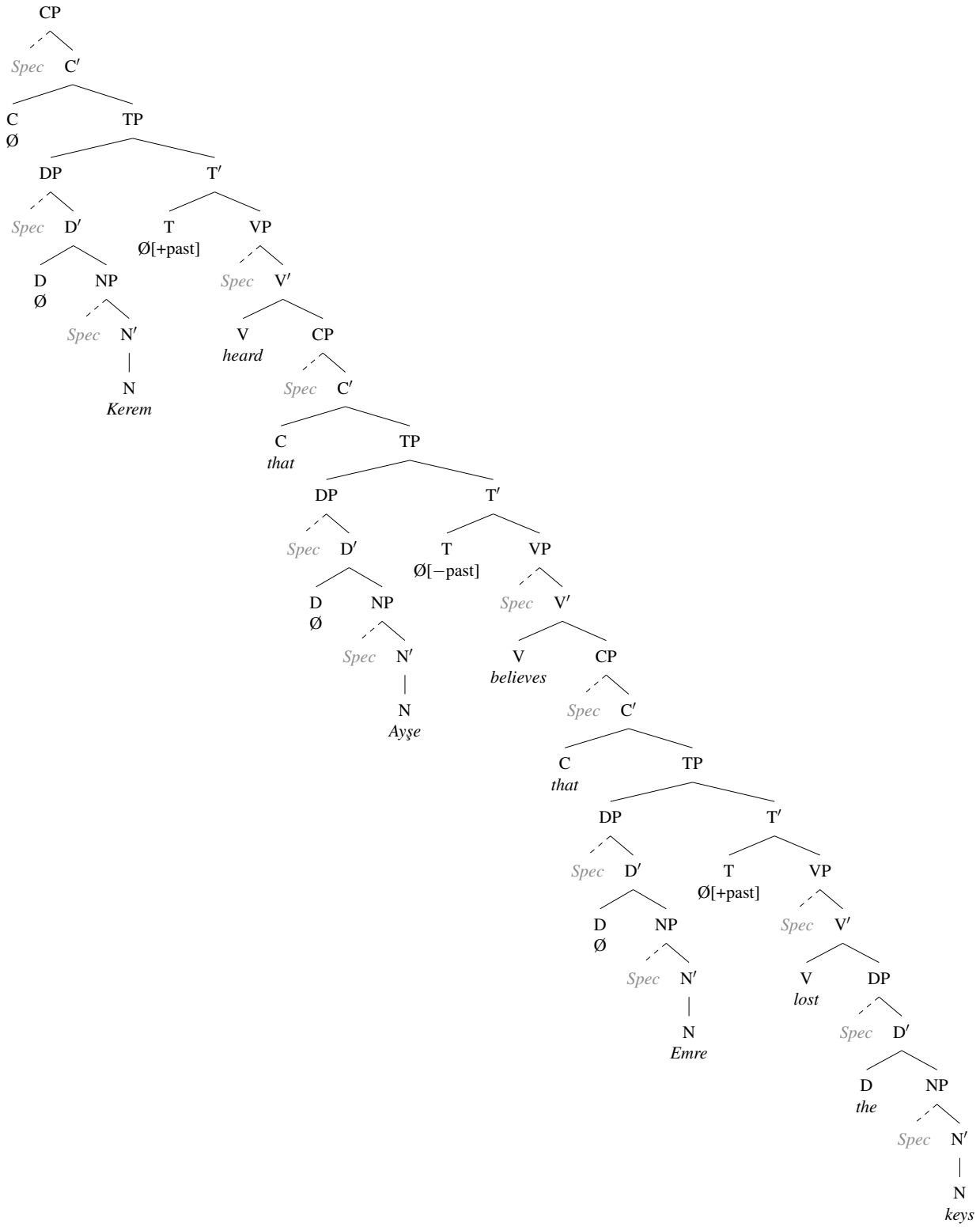
Practice: sentential subject: a that-CP in Spec,TP



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [CP [C′ [C *That*] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Beşiktaş*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[+past]] [VP [V′ [V *won*]]]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[+past]] [VP [V′ [V *surprised*] [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Onur*]]]]]]]]]]

3.4 Kerem heard that Ayşe believes that Emre lost the keys.

Practice: two levels of embedding: a that-CP inside a that-CP



[CP [C′ [C Ø] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Kerem*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[+past]] [VP [V′ [V *heard*] [CP [C′ [C *that*] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Ayşe*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[−past]] [VP [V′ [V *believes*] [CP [C′ [C *that*] [TP [DP [D′ [D Ø] [NP [N′ [N *Emre*]]]]] [T′ [T Ø[+past]] [VP [V′ [V *lost*] [DP [D′ [D *the*] [NP [N′ [N *keys*]]]]